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Prof. Dr. Catherine De Wolf

Chair of Circular Engineering for Architecture (CEA)

Department of Civil, Environmental and Geomatic Engineering (D-BAUG)

ETH Zurich

Subject: Spontaneous application — research / PhD opportunities in Circular Engineering for Architecture

Dear Prof. De Wolf,

I am writing to apply spontaneously for PhD or research opportunities in your Chair of Circular Engineering for Architecture at ETH Zurich. Your work on using digital methods to help construction reuse materials — documenting what exists, recovering components, matching them to new projects, and checking environmental impact — is the direction I want to take. I would be happy to discuss whether there is a fit with current or upcoming openings in your group.

I hold a Master's in Environmental Engineering from HTW Dresden and a Bachelor's and Diploma in Civil Engineering. In my master's thesis, *Agile Project Management in the Construction Industry*, I looked at how Agile can help construction teams collaborate, manage risk and use resources more carefully. That work also opened a wider interest for me: what happens to materials when a building reaches the end of its life. Since then I have kept learning about circular construction, material flows and GIS, including how information gaps make people choose new materials when reused ones could work.

At Aug.e I worked on digital twins for smart buildings — using a digital model to understand how a real building performs. At Hive CPQ I managed large product datasets from manufacturers and turned complex information into tools that non-technical users could work with. At iostriing I worked with a construction partner on a circular construction hypothesis: how Agile project management can bring circular practices into real projects. From these roles I bring experience with construction data, stakeholders, digital tools and GIS. I have been on a career break to care for my newborns, and I kept learning about this field during that time.

What draws me to CEA is how your research connects circular construction with practical digital workflows: reality capture and documentation of existing stock, clearer information for reuse and material matchmaking, design that starts from reclaimed components, and life-cycle thinking to measure impact. That mix of engineering, digital methods and real reuse projects matches both my background and the problems I most want to work on. I am especially interested in research that helps turn reclaimed materials from an exception into a planned part of design and delivery.

I am based in Pune, India, and open to relocating to Zurich for a doctoral or research role. I work in a calm and structured way, communicate clearly with technical and non-technical partners, and enjoy applied work with industry. I would welcome the chance to discuss opportunities in your group and to share how I could contribute and learn within CEA.

Yours sincerely,

Pooja Awasare